

Montreal Parental Village

Volunteer Policy and Agreement

For All Volunteers of Montreal Parental Village

This document constitutes both the organizational policy governing volunteers and the individual agreement to be signed by each volunteer.

PART A — VOLUNTEER POLICY

1. Purpose

Montreal Parental Village values the extraordinary contribution of volunteers who share our commitment to supporting single-parent families. This policy establishes the framework for recruiting, engaging, recognizing, and parting ways with volunteers, ensuring a safe, respectful, and meaningful experience for all.

2. Volunteer Eligibility

- Individuals 18 years of age or older may volunteer without restriction
- Individuals aged 15–17 may volunteer with written parental/guardian consent and with appropriate supervision
- Volunteers working directly with children must provide a valid criminal record check (Vérification des antécédents judiciaires) and a vulnerable sector check, renewed every three years
- All volunteers must agree to abide by this Policy and the Organization's Code of Ethics and Conduct

3. Recruitment and Onboarding

3.1 Application

Prospective volunteers complete a Volunteer Application Form describing their background, skills, motivations, and availability. Applications are reviewed by the Volunteer Coordinator.

3.2 Interview

Selected candidates participate in an orientation interview to discuss roles, expectations, schedule, and organizational culture.

3.3 Background Checks

Volunteers in roles involving children or vulnerable adults must consent to and pass a background check prior to beginning service. The Organization bears the cost of background checks.

3.4 Orientation

All new volunteers complete a mandatory orientation covering: organizational mission and values, the Code of Ethics and Conduct, child protection protocols, emergency and safety procedures, applicable policies (privacy, accessibility, anti-harassment), and the specific responsibilities of their role.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

4.1 Volunteer Responsibilities

- Fulfill agreed-upon commitments with diligence and reliability
- Communicate promptly if unable to fulfil a scheduled commitment
- Treat all members, staff, children, and fellow volunteers with respect and kindness
- Maintain confidentiality of all organizational and personal information
- Report concerns about safety, misconduct, or policy violations to the Volunteer Coordinator

4.2 Organizational Responsibilities

- Provide clear role descriptions and task guidance
- Ensure adequate supervision and support
- Provide a safe, inclusive working environment
- Recognize volunteer contributions formally and informally
- Ensure volunteers are not required to perform work that displaces paid staff

5. Supervision

Each volunteer is assigned to a staff supervisor who provides day-to-day guidance. Volunteers with direct child contact must be supervised by a responsible adult at all times. The Volunteer Coordinator maintains the overall volunteer schedule and liaises with supervisors.

6. Expenses and Benefits

Volunteers are not employees and receive no remuneration. The Organization may, where budget allows, reimburse reasonable, pre-approved out-of-pocket expenses (travel, materials) upon submission of receipts. Volunteers may receive non-monetary recognition such as letters of reference, appreciation events, or training opportunities.

7. Hours and Scheduling

Volunteer hours are agreed upon in advance and recorded in the Organization's volunteer management system. Minimum commitments may be set for specific roles. Volunteers may not volunteer more than the agreed maximum hours without written approval, to ensure appropriate supervision.

8. Health, Safety, and Insurance

The Organization carries liability insurance that covers volunteers performing their assigned duties. Volunteers must follow all health and safety protocols. The Organization is not responsible for personal injury or property damage resulting from a volunteer acting outside their approved scope of activities.

9. Confidentiality and Privacy

Volunteers have access to sensitive personal information about members. All such information is strictly confidential and must not be shared with any unauthorized person. Volunteers must comply with the Organization's Privacy Policy at all times. This obligation continues after the end of volunteer engagement.

10. Conduct and Disciplinary Procedure

Volunteers are expected to adhere to the Code of Ethics and Conduct. In cases of alleged misconduct, the following steps may be taken:

- 1. Informal discussion with supervisor
- 2. Formal written warning
- 3. Suspension pending investigation
- 4. Termination of volunteer engagement

In cases of serious misconduct (especially involving child safety), immediate suspension and referral to appropriate authorities will occur.

11. Ending a Volunteer Engagement

Either the volunteer or the Organization may end the engagement at any time. Where possible, volunteers are asked to provide two weeks' notice. Exit interviews are offered to all departing volunteers. All organizational materials, access credentials, and confidential information must be returned or deleted upon departure.

12. Recognition

Montreal Parental Village values and celebrates its volunteers through annual recognition events, reference letters, certificates of appreciation, and acknowledgement in organizational communications.

PART B — VOLUNTEER AGREEMENT

I, the undersigned, agree to volunteer with Montreal Parental Village under the terms of the Volunteer Policy above and the Organization's Code of Ethics and Conduct. I understand that my role as a volunteer is not employment and that I am not entitled to remuneration.

Volunteer Information

Full Name:	
Date of Birth:	
Address:	
Phone:	
Email:	
Emergency Contact:	
Emergency Phone:	
Proposed Role:	
Availability:	
Start Date:	

Background Check Consent

If my volunteer role involves working with children or vulnerable persons, I consent to a criminal record check and vulnerable sector check.

Consent (Yes / No):	
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Acknowledgements

- I have read and understood the Volunteer Policy
- I have read and understood the Code of Ethics and Conduct
- I agree to maintain confidentiality of all personal and organizational information
- I understand that this engagement may be ended at any time by either party
- I acknowledge receipt of the Volunteer Orientation materials

Volunteer Signature:	Date:
Accepted by (Org. Representative):	Date: